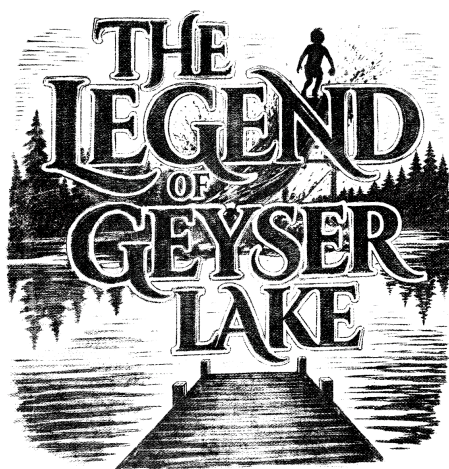
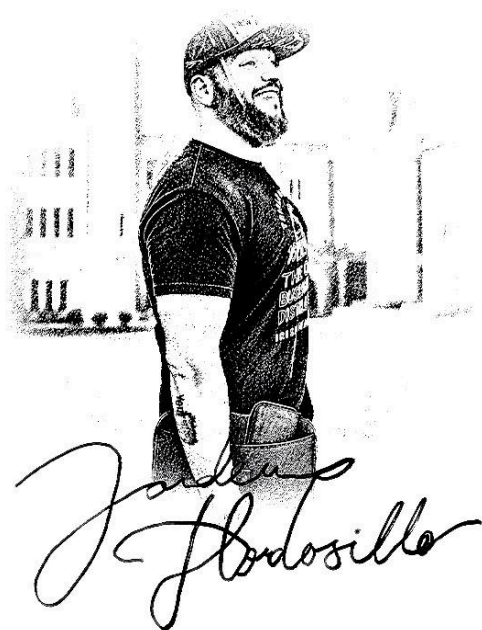






A Poem

J
H



Javier Hernandez is a proud member of



NORTH CAROLINA
POETRY SOCIETY

Academy of American
POETS

NWU NATIONAL
WRITERS
UNION

Poets & Writers



HUMAN
AUTHORS
GUILD

The Legend of Geyser Lake
Copyright © 2026 by Jaiden Hordosillo

All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed, stored, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission of the publisher, except in the case of brief quotations used in reviews, criticism, scholarship, or educational reference.

Publisher Cataloging Data

Hordosillo, Jaiden, born 1989
The Legend of Geyser Lake: a poem / Jaiden Hordosillo.
Durham, North Carolina: Jaiden Hordosillo, 2026.
26 page; 20 cm
ISBN: 978-1-956116-11-3

Summary

A haunting tale of curiosity, consequence, and the echoes left decades after one act of childhood impatience becomes the topic of a local folk legend.

Subjects

American poetry—21st century.
Narrative poetry, American.
Folk poetry, American.
Legends—Poetry.
Missing children—Poetry.
Water parks—Poetry.

Classification

LCC PS3608.O7335 L44 2026
DDC 811/.6—dc23

Identifiers

ORCID: 0009-0005-4147-4231

Published by Jaiden Hordosillo
Durham, North Carolina
www.hordosillo.com
First Edition
ISBN: 978-1-956116-11-3
DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21299836
Library of Congress Control Number [LCCN]: *pending*

This publication forms part of an ongoing literary archive. Metadata, preservation records, and associated materials are maintained through independent archival and repository systems to support long-term access, citation, and scholarly reference. Poem, introduction, reflection, and design by Jaiden Hordosillo. Printed in the United States of America.

Recommended Citation

Hordosillo, Jaiden. *The Legend of Geyser Lake.*
Durham, North Carolina: Jaiden Hordosillo, 2026.
ISBN 978-1-956116-11-3.

*Thank you to Bright Sun Films for inspiring me to go
to the water park that gave me this story.*

contents

<i>Perspective.....</i>	<i>10</i>
<i>Legend of Geyser Lake.....</i>	<i>15</i>
<i>Final Reflection.....</i>	<i>18</i>

Perspective

I first had the idea for this story in 2018 when I visited a newly reopened water park that had been rumored online to be the abandoned Disney resort known as Mowgli's Palace. Of course, this wasn't true, and anyone visiting the property could identify that rather quickly, but it still made my mind wander.

When I stood at the top of its largest slide, looking down at the scattered rocks below, thoughts of a child falling onto them overtook my imagination. The rocks were wet, the edge had no guardrail, and the entire thing looked as if it were begging for an accident.

That's where the idea began. I would play with the concept for years through flash fiction and short stories, but nothing ever felt right.

Recently, while going through my IMDb credits, I came across a nursery rhyme I had written for a short film about Velma Barfield, a serial killer from the town where I grew up. Just reading those words I wrote so many years ago rekindled my love for a style of poetry I had forgotten I loved.

Growing up in Robeson County, North Carolina, I was surrounded by cautionary tales, local legends, and ghost stories. Folk legends have a unique ability to travel across generations, never belonging entirely to one age group. A story that chills a child can later terrify an adult.

I always loved that about nursery rhymes.

I remember watching a documentary as a child about Nirvana working on the album *Nevermind*. I recall Kurt Cobain saying that he didn't want to be influenced by other "grunge" bands. Instead, he wanted to create the catchiest melodies he could. He initially studied pop music, but his greatest inspiration eventually became nursery rhymes.

I immediately thought of all the nursery rhymes I knew, and he was right. I was amazed by how many I could recall without even remembering the last time I had heard or recited them.

Mother Goose was the first pop lyricist.

That concept stuck with me more than I realized at the time, especially after considering how dark those poems appeared in retrospect. It made sense that an album containing a song like "*Polly*" could be

influenced by dark poetry disguised as a
child's chant.

When I rediscovered the nursery rhyme I
had written for that film all those years ago, I
felt inspired to return to the art form. I
asked myself: What stories did I have that
could fit this peculiar style of poetry?

*And then I remembered the water park.**

Legend of Geyser Lake

In 1998,
nine-year-old
Jackson Blake
could hardly wait
for opening day
of *Geyser Lake*.

But he was grounded
and missed the date,
so that night
he jumped the gate.

But when the sun
rose awake,

neither park
nor parent
could find a trace.

Now every night
at *Geyser Lake*,
you can hear the splash
of the boy
who jumped the gate.*

Final Reflection

While there has never been much evidence that nursery rhymes contain the specific hidden meanings later assigned to them, I have always found our instinct to search for darkness within them to be evidence of something else.

Nursery rhymes are folk songs, passed down from one generation to the next, usually through childhood. We learn them before we are old enough to question them, long before we even understand what those words might mean.

Humpty Dumpty was about a fall. *Jack and Jill* was as well. *Ring Around the Rosie* also ended

with everyone falling down. But each one represents a different kind of fall. They warn of danger, disobedience, carelessness, sickness, and consequence— all disguised as songs for children.

But what does it say about the adult mind that it searches for darkness within childhood images? Is the darkness truly hidden inside the rhyme, or do we place it there once we are old enough to understand what can happen?

Perhaps that is simply part of aging. *The Legend of Geyser Lake* serves as a cautionary tale for children not to disobey their parents. For an adult, however, it becomes something far more frightening: the story of a parent who must endure the disappearance of a child.

The child hears a warning.

The parent hears a nightmare.

The words never change. Only the fear does.
I have to admit, I am beyond excited to
continue exploring this concept.

There are countless stories I have written
over the years waiting to be remembered as
legends hiding inside the kinds of rhymes
we are intended to repeat without fear,
simply waiting for the reader to become old
enough to be afraid of them. *



Archival Statement

This edition of *The Legend of Geyser Lake* was written, edited, designed, and published by Jaiden Hordosillo.

Set in Baskerville.

This edition was published as part of Jaiden Hordosillo's Single Poem Editions series, an ongoing effort dedicated to the preservation, publication, and study of contemporary poetry.

A digital archival copy of this publication is maintained through DOI registration and independent repository preservation systems.

Cover Illustrated by: Jaiden Hordosillo

First edition, 2026.

978-1-956116-11-3

Durham, North Carolina, USA.

www.hordosillo.com/thelegendofgeyserlake



About the Author

Jaiden Hordosillo is a poet, publisher, and literary scholar based in Durham, North Carolina. His work explores memory, identity, place, and the hidden narratives contained within everyday life.

ORCID: 0009-0005-4147-4231

***ATTENTION: LIBRARIES, SCHOOLS, AND
LITERARY ORGANIZATIONS***

Single poem publications are available for library collections,
educational use, literary programming, and archival
acquisition.

Institutions interested in obtaining copies for collections,
classrooms, workshops, exhibitions, or public programs may
contact the publisher directly. For information regarding
educational use, readings, archival acquisitions, or bulk
orders, please contact me at:

www.hordosillo.com

editorial@hordosillo.com

(919) 808-1443

Office Hours:

12:00-5:30 pm

Monday through Friday

Mailing Address:

323 E Chapel Hill St. #114

Durham, North Carolina, 27701

J
H[®]